Instacart Shopper

Complete Account Opening Guide

Grocery Shopping & Delivery Service

Welcome to your comprehensive Instacart Shopper guide! Instacart is a leading grocery delivery platform that connects shoppers with customers who need groceries delivered to their homes. As a Full-Service Shopper, you'll shop for items at stores like Costco, Safeway, Kroger, Publix, and more, then deliver them directly to customers. This guide walks you through every step to maximize your chances of approval.

Requirements Before You Start

- Must be at least 18 years old
- Eligible to work in the United States
- Smartphone with iOS 14+ or Android 8+ and reliable internet
- Reliable vehicle for grocery deliveries (car, van, or SUV)
- Valid driver's license and auto insurance
- Ability to lift and carry grocery bags weighing 30-40 lbs
- Pass a background check
- Social Security Number
- Bank account or debit card for payments

- Insulated bags for cold/frozen items (recommended)

Step 1: Download the Instacart Shopper App

- Open the App Store (iPhone) or Google Play Store (Android)
- Search for "Instacart Shopper" - NOT the regular Instacart customer app
- Look for the app with the GREEN shopping bag icon
- The correct app is specifically for shoppers/delivery drivers
- Download and install the official Instacart Shopper app
- Make sure you have a stable internet connection during setup

■ TIP: The Shopper app has a green carrot icon - the customer app looks different!

Step 2: Create Your Shopper Account

- Open the Instacart Shopper app and tap "Become a Shopper" or "Sign Up"
- Enter your email address - use one you check regularly
- Create a strong, secure password
- Enter and verify your mobile phone number via SMS code
- CRITICAL: When asked for your shopping zone, enter a ZIP CODE from GIG ZipFinder
- Select "Full-Service Shopper" to shop AND deliver (earns more than in-store only)
- In-Store Shoppers only shop and don't deliver - Full-Service is recommended

■ TIP: Full-Service Shoppers typically earn more due to delivery tips!

Step 3: Complete Identity Verification

- Enter your full legal name exactly as it appears on your ID
- Provide your date of birth (must be 18+)
- Enter your Social Security Number for background check and taxes
- Take a clear, well-lit photo of the FRONT of your driver's license
- Take a clear photo of the BACK of your driver's license

- Take a selfie for facial recognition verification
- Ensure your selfie matches your ID photo closely

■ TIP: Good lighting is essential - natural daylight works best for document photos.

Step 4: Provide Vehicle Information

- Enter your vehicle make (manufacturer) - e.g., Toyota, Honda
- Enter your vehicle model - e.g., RAV4, CR-V, Accord
- Enter the year of your vehicle
- Provide your license plate number exactly as shown
- Confirm your vehicle can safely transport grocery orders
- Larger vehicles (SUVs, vans) can handle bigger Costco orders
- Some areas allow bike delivery for smaller orders

■ TIP: A spacious trunk or cargo area helps you take larger, higher-paying batches.

Step 5: Background Check Process

- Review and consent to the background check by Checkr
- The check reviews your driving record (MVR) and criminal history
- Background checks typically take 5-10 business days
- You'll receive email notifications with updates on your status
- Some applicants are approved within 24-48 hours
- Check your spam folder if you don't see updates
- Contact Instacart support if your check takes longer than 14 days

■ TIP: Keep your phone notifications enabled for real-time status updates.

Step 6: Complete Training & Start Shopping

- Once approved, complete the in-app orientation and tutorial
- Learn how to navigate stores and find items efficiently
- Set up your payment method (instant cashout or weekly direct deposit)

- Enable location services on your phone for accurate order matching
- Set your availability schedule - more hours = more opportunities
- Get your insulated bags ready for cold/frozen items
- Start accepting batches and earning money!

■ TIP: Complete Instacart's free "Shopper Academy" lessons to improve your skills!

Pro Tips for Instacart Success

✓ Learn store layouts to shop faster - speed increases your hourly earnings

✓ Communicate with customers through the app if items are out of stock

✓ Take photos of receipts and delivered groceries for proof

✓ Higher ratings unlock access to better-paying batches

✓ Shop during peak hours: 9-11 AM, 4-7 PM, and weekends

✓ Costco and wholesale club orders typically pay more

✓ Keep insulated bags in your car to protect temperature-sensitive items

✓ Double-check orders before delivery to ensure accuracy

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